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Postal Manual Vol IV

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Chapter 1: Establishment Norms and Reviews

1. General Procedure for Establishment Proposals

1. All proposals formulated by Divisional Heads of Postal/Railway Mail Service, Chief Postmasters, or Executive Engineers/Superintendent Engineers must be submitted by the **Heads of Circles** directly to the **Director General**. In such instances, the documents containing the proposals shall be forwarded to the sanctioning authority by the Head of the Circle, in consultation with the Circle Internal Financial Advisor (IFA).

2. Proposals specifically relating to Business Development (BD) and Marketing, Postal Life Insurance (PLI), Postal Directorate, or the Civil Wing must be routed through the respective Chief General Managers (CGMs), Deputy Directors General (DDGs), or Chief Engineers (Civil).

3. Every proposal must be submitted to the Director General within the following timelines prior to the desired date of sanction:

- **3 months** in advance for fixed establishments.
- **2 months** in advance for temporary establishments.

In cases concerning the Postal and Railway Mail Service, the proposal must be supported by a statistical memorandum and a copy of the valuation where necessary.

2. Justification and Financial Implications

4. Every communication proposing the creation, revision, or abolition of fixed establishments must comprehensively explain the grounds for the proposal and clearly outline the financial effect. The proposal must detail:

1. The **present cost** of the establishment or the portion of the establishment affected.

2. Details of the **number and pay** of the appointments proposed to be added or modified.

3. The **cost after revision** of the establishment concerned, presented in a tabular format.

For calculation purposes, establishment charges are classified into four categories:

(i) For Head Offices or Large Sub-Offices:

- Clerical establishment.
- Delivery establishment.
- Multi-Tasking Staff (MTS) establishment (formerly Class IV).
- Contingent allowances, house rent, etc..

(ii) For Railway Mail Service (RMS) Divisions:

- Sorting Assistant establishment.
- Mail Guards establishment.
- Multi-Tasking Staff (MTS) establishment.
- Other items such as contingent allowance, allowances for attendants at rest houses, etc..

5. Definition of Office Establishment.

"Office establishment" includes all non-gazetted servants engaged in clerical duties, as well as MTS employed in offices, excluding sweepers.

6. Transfer of Establishment Charges.

When proposing to transfer an appointment or establishment charge from one office or division to another, the proposal must contain:

- (a) The abolition of the appointment/charge in the old office/division.
- (b) The simultaneous creation of the appointment/charge in the new office/division.

7. Value Returns.

A value return in Form Est. 5 or Est. 6(a) must be submitted with every proposal regarding22:

1. Experimental Post Offices.
2. Increasing the establishment charge of a Branch Office.
3. Converting a Branch Office into a Sub-Office.
4. Closing an office on the grounds of being un-remunerative.
5. Increasing the cost of mail lines that benefit Branch Offices only.

3. Registers and Periodical Reviews

8. A Register of Sanctioned Establishments must be maintained by Divisions in Form A.C.G. 19(a), which is also used for the same purpose in Head Offices.

9. Periodical Review of Work.

The Head of the Circle shall arrange to receive statistics of work from each Head Office and larger Sub-Offices at fixed intervals. These reviews are conducted based on the prescribed Time Tests (e.g., Bewoor's Time Tests or current equivalents)29. The standard intervals for review are:

- **Every year:** All GPOs / Head Offices / MDGs.
- **Every 3 years:** LSG / HSG Sub-Offices.
- **Every 3 years:** Class I Sub-Offices.

- **Every 3 years:** Other Town / Sub-Offices.
- **Every 3 years:** Branch Offices.
- **Every 3 years:** Revision of allowances for GDS BPMs and other GDS.

10. Statistical reviews of Mail Offices, TMOs, Sub-Record Offices, Record Offices, and Sections must be conducted **every year** as per prescribed rules.

11. The establishment review of Divisional Offices, Postal Stores Depots (PSD), and Returned Letter Offices (RLO) shall be carried out **every 3 years**.

12. Road Establishment :

The road establishment (number of ABPMs) for each mail line depends on the length of the line and the weight of mails. Wherever practicable, the same ABPM should carry mails in both directions over their stage.

4. Norms for Opening Branch Post Offices (GDS Posts)

13. The norms for opening Branch Post Offices in rural areas are governed by the revised criteria applicable to Gramin Dak Sevaks.

Parameters	Normal Areas	Hilly, Tribal, Desert, and Inaccessible Areas
Population	**3,000** population in a group of villages (for new BOs).	**500** population in an individual village or **1,000** in a group of villages.
Distance	Minimum distance from the nearest Post Office: **3 K.M.**.	The distance limit is the same, but in hilly areas, the minimum distance limit can be relaxed by the Directorate.
Anticipated Income	Minimum anticipated revenue: **15%** of the cost.	Minimum anticipated income: **10%** of the cost.

📝 **LEGISLATIVE NOTE:** The income norms have been updated to reflect the current GDS Committee recommendations (implemented vide OM No. 17-110/2016-GDS dated 25.06.2017). The previous requirement of **33.33%** for Normal Areas and **15%** for Tribal Areas has been substituted with **15%** and **10%** respectively to facilitate broader rural coverage.

Chapter 2: Experimental Post Offices and Revenue Calculations

1. Regulations for Experimental Post Offices

14. Sanction Period :

No experimental Post Office, Postman, or Village Postman may be sanctioned for a period exceeding 6 months at a time. No extension for an experimental Post Office may be sanctioned unless there is a reasonable expectation that the office will become self-supporting at the end of 2 years.

15. Permanency Criteria :

Except in the case of experimental offices opened in large towns, no experimental office may be made permanent unless its total income covers its total cost plus 25% of the cost.

16. Closure of Unremunerative Offices :

If an experimental office in a village proves to be unremunerative even after 24 months, the office may be closed.

17. Procedure for Opening :

If the Superintendent's proposal for an experimental Post Office is approved, the Head of Circle (HOC) will issue an order to the Superintendent for opening the experimental Post Office for a period of 6 months. A copy of this order is simultaneously sent to the Head Office and the Audit Office.

2. Calculation of Office Income

18. The income of all Post Offices (Rural and Urban) shall be calculated based on the following percentages and rates:

- **Money Orders (Issued): 24%** of the commission realized.
- **Money Orders (Paid): 38%** of the commission that would have been realized.
- **Indian Postal Orders (Sold): 2/5th** of the commission realized.
- **Indian Postal Orders (Paid): 2/5th** of the commission that would have been realized.
- **Other Agency Functions: 1%** of the total income on other items (postage, money orders, postal orders, savings bank, and certificates) where these functions are performed.

Reimbursement Rates for Savings and Schemes (FY 2023-24 Basis):

- **POSB (Live Account):** Rs. 219.23 per annum.
- **POSB (Silent Account):** Rs. 35.61 per annum.
- **Savings Certificate Transaction (KVP & NSC):** Rs. 73.92 per transaction.
- **Kisan Vikas Patra (IVP):** Rs. 19.59.
- **MGNREGA Wage Payment:** Rs. 24.88 per active account per annum (performed by B.O. and reimbursed by Ministry of Finance).

Chapter 3: Rules Relating to Departmental Examinations

1. Conduct of Examinations

1. Notice of Examination :

An advance notice of a minimum period of 40 days must be issued for every departmental examination.

2. Scheduling :

Dates for examinations must be selected carefully to avoid conflict with important festivals (National/Regional) and National Holidays.

3. Applications and Marks :

All applications regarding departmental examinations (e.g., re-totaling) must be submitted through the proper channel17. Candidates may also seek communication of marks through Right to Information (RTI) applications.

4. Withdrawal of Candidature :

Permission to withdraw candidature may be granted by the same authority that granted permission to appear for the examination.

5. Withdrawal After Roll Number Assignment :

Once roll numbers have been assigned, a candidate is generally not permitted to withdraw their candidature, except in circumstances beyond their control.

6. Evaluation Integrity :

To ensure the accuracy of mechanical evaluation, a cross-checking of 10% of OMR sheets must be carried out through manual evaluation by a nominated Committee or Officers.

7. Declaration of Results :

The results of the examination should preferably be declared within 60 days from the date of the conduct of the examination.

8. Revaluation :

Revaluation of answer scripts is not permissible in any case or under any circumstances.

2. Record Preservation and Security

9. Answer Books :

OMR sheets and Answer Books must be preserved for a period of 12 months from the date of the declaration of the result.

10. Result Sheets :

Tabulated result sheets or mark sheet registers for all examinations must be preserved for a period of 3 years from the date of announcement of the respective results.

11. Litigation Records :

Records related to court cases, vigilance cases, disputes, or RTI matters must be preserved until the finalization of such cases. Thereafter, suitable orders must be obtained from the Competent Authority for disposal.

12. Unfair Means :

If a departmental candidate is found guilty of using unfair means or copying, the supervising officer must forward a report to the competent authority to impose a major penalty on the candidate.

13. CCTV Surveillance :

It must be ensured that Examination Halls and Centre Supervisors' offices are covered by CCTV recording (either permanently installed or hired). CCTV footage must be preserved in the personal custody of the DPS (HQ) for 2 years after the declaration of results.

3. Competent Authorities for Paper Setting

14. The level of officers designated as Question Paper Setters for various examinations is as follows:

Examination Cadre	Level of Officer for Paper Setter
Postal Assistant / Sorting Assistant	JAG & above
Postman / Mail Guard	STS / JAG & above
MTS	JTS / STS & above
LDCE Inspector Posts	JAG / SAG
LDCE PS Group B	HAG

Chapter 4: Recruitment, Appointment, and Transfers

1. Re-employment and Age Limits

1. Re-employment of Pensioners :

The Head of a Circle may sanction the re-employment of pensioners in non-gazetted posts under Article 520 (iii) of the Civil Service Regulations (CSR). An appointing authority of gazetted rank in charge of a Division or a First-Class Head Post Office may also exercise this power, provided the pensioner is re-employed within their jurisdiction.

2. Suitability for Re-employment :

No pensioner whose past records and present circumstances are not fully satisfactory, especially regarding financial solvency, should be considered suitable for re-employment.

3. Age Limit Relaxation :

Candidates whose age exceeds the prescribed maximum age limits will not be eligible for recruitment to the cadres concerned. The maximum age limit cannot be relaxed by the Heads of Circles (HOC). Where no specific delegation has been made, the powers for such relaxation vest in the Government, and all such cases must be referred to the Director-General prior to recruitment.

4. Age at Appointment :

No separate sanction is necessary in a case where a candidate is within the maximum age limit at the time of recruitment but becomes over-aged by the time of actual appointment.

5. Leave Reserve (LR) :

A staff of assistants not exceeding 10% of the operative clerical staff is sanctioned to form a Leave Reserve (LR).

2. Maintenance of Gradation Lists

6. Circle Gradation List :

The Head of Circle shall publish the gradation list once in 5 years and issue copies to all concerned. The Circle gradation list is corrected up to 1st July (32-A).

7. Divisional Gradation List :

The Divisional gradation list should be compiled once in 3 years (32-B).

8. Format :

All gradation lists should be maintained in Form App. 44. In each list, the names of the officials of each class should be entered separately and in strict order of seniority, with one or more pages left blank after each class for updates.

9. Rectification of Errors :

If there is any mistake in a gradation list, the official(s) concerned must point it out to the Authority for rectification within one year of the date of issue of the list.

3. Seniority Rules

10. (a) Recruitment through Examination:

- If the examination is competitive, seniority is fixed according to the **order of merit** in the examination.
- Where recruitment is made partly from departmental candidates and partly from outsiders, the departmental candidates shall always rank **senior** to the outsiders.

- **(b) Recruitment by Promotion:**
  - If promotion is based on pure selection, seniority is fixed according to the **order of preference**.

4. Transfer Guidelines

11. General Liability (Rule-37) :

All officials of the Department are liable to be transferred to any part of India in the interest of service14.

12. Timing of Transfers (Rule-37-A) :

Transfers should generally be executed in April of each year to ensure the education of school-going children is not dislocated. This restriction does not apply in emergent cases or cases of promotion15.

13. Transfer at Own Request (Rule-38) :

Applications for transfer under Rule-38 (Inter-Circle, Intra-Circle, Mutual, etc.) must be submitted through the online system. The following provisions apply:

- **(a) Eligibility:** Officials must complete **one year** of service to be eligible. The one-year condition is waived if the spouse/dependent children are suffering from a terminal illness or if the appointment is on compassionate grounds.

📝 **LEGISLATIVE NOTE: Inspectors of Posts (IP)** and **Assistant Superintendents of Posts (ASP)** are eligible for Inter-Circle transfer under Rule-38 with effect from **01.06.2024**.

- **(b) Frequency:** An official is eligible for **two Inter-Circle** and **two Intra-Circle** transfers during their entire service.
  - A mandatory gap of **3 years** is required for a second transfer in the same category.
  - **PWD candidates** are entitled to **one additional chance** in both categories.
- **(c) Withdrawal and Decline:**
  - An employee can withdraw the request on the online portal at any time.
  - Employees may decline a provisionally approved transfer on the portal within **72 hours** of allotment.
  - If an employee cancels an approved transfer after the 72-hour window or after the final order is issued, they will be deemed to have **availed one chance** of transfer.
- **(d) Competent Authority:**
  - **Inter-Circle:** CPMG of both Circles.
  - **Intra-Circle (Change of Region):** CPMG.

  - **Intra-Region:** PMG.

- **(e) Cycle:** Transfers are considered on a half-yearly basis in **March** and **September**. Requests received till the preceding month are included in the priority list.

- **(f) Relieving Norms:** Relieving shall **not be denied** solely on the ground of staff shortage if the working strength of the cadre in the Division/Unit is not less than **66.66%**.

- **(g) Relieving Timeline:** An official approved for transfer must invariably be relieved within **30 days** of the issue of the order. This may be extended to a maximum of **60 days** upon the written request of the official.

5. Tenure and Officiating Arrangements

Officiating Arrangements :

50 of Postal Manual Vol. IV provides for officiating arrangements for short-term vacancies for a period not exceeding 4 months.

15. Tenure of Posts.

- **Post Tenure:** The tenure for the posts of Superintendent of Post Offices, RMS, and Inspector of Posts/RMS shall not exceed **3 years** at a time, except under special conditions.

- **Station Tenure:** The maximum tenure at one station shall be **6 years**.